PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

# Ford Bronco (sixth generation)

2021–present · U725 · 2-DOOR · 4-DOOR · RAPTOR

BOXYTRUCKS

## CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Run the VIN before anything else**
  There are many open-recall possibilities. The big ones are the 2.7 intake valves (24V-635), the rear shock reservoirs (25V-025), 2021–22 molded-in-color roof panels (26V-299, remedy expected November 2026), engine-bay wiring (26V-468), fender flares (26V-403) and, on 2024–25 trucks, loose front control-arm and ball-joint fasteners (24V-770, 25V-260, 25V-308, 25V-310). Get a printout from NHTSA's VIN lookup.

- [ ] **Look hard at the hardtop**
  Molded-in-color tops were standard on 2021–23 trucks and most 2024s. Crazing or delamination means the top needs replacing: Ford's August 2021 program fitted 'MIC 2.0' tops, and some owners are on their third or fourth. Painted tops arrived for 2025. Check the headliner and seals for leaks and make sure every panel latches.

- [ ] **2.7 V6: ask about the engine test**
  Recall 24V-635 covers 2021–22 2.7 and 3.0 Nano EcoBoost engines whose intake valves can break. Dealers run an engine cycle test and replace the engine if needed. Bronco Nation names V6s built from May 1 to October 31, 2021 as the bad batch. Get proof the test was done.

- [ ] **Rear shocks on Badlands and Sasquatch**
  Bilstein rear shocks on trucks built from September 23, 2020 to July 23, 2024 can corrode until the external reservoir detaches (25V-025). Look at the reservoirs and their mounts and confirm the replacement was done.

- [ ] **Drive the manual through every gear**
  On 2021–23 seven-speed trucks, a scraping noise in neutral, first or second is the subject of a Ford service bulletin. Check for clean engagement of the crawler gear and reverse.

- [ ] **Steering and tie rods on modified trucks**
  Owners have reported tie rods failing during hard off-road use, usually on lifted trucks with bigger tires. Inspect the inner and outer tie rods for bends. The 2023 Wildtrak and 2022 Raptor had a steering-gear recall (23V-155) for internal damage that could lock the wheel.

- [ ] **Was it flat-towed?**
  2021–22 trucks had a neutral-tow problem: Ford issued a temporary fix in May 2022 and an over-the-air update by March 2023. Bronco Nation warns that flat-tow damage to the transmission can be hard to get covered under warranty, so ask how the truck traveled behind a motorhome.

- [ ] **Is it a real Sasquatch?**
  Factory Sasquatch trucks have 315/70R17 tires on 17×8.5, +30 mm wheels and 4.7 gears. A truck that only has aftermarket 35s may still have the original gearing and +55 mm wheels. Check the window sticker or the build data.

## YEARS TO KNOW

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|---|---|---|
| **2021** | BEWARE | Production starts June 14, 2021 at Michigan Assembly. 2.3 (manual or auto) and 2.7 (auto) EcoBoost; Base, Big Bend, Black Diamond, Outer Banks, Badlands, Wildtrak and First Edition; Sasquatch package. CarGurus says to steer clear of 2021–22: the year with the most recalls, including 2.7 intake valves (24V-635), molded-in-color roof panels and airbags. |
| **2022** | BEWARE | Bronco Raptor (four-door, 3.0 twin-turbo V6, 37s) and the four-door-only Everglades edition arrive. Still inside the 2.7 valve recall, and 2021–22 molded-in-color roof panels are recalled in 2026; CarGurus says to avoid it. |
| **2023** | SWEET SPOT | Heritage Edition and Heritage Limited Edition arrive, both with a painted top instead of the molded-in-color one. CarGurus' pick of the generation, with fewer complaints than 2021–22, provided the recalls are done. |

## RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **2.7/3.0 Nano EcoBoost intake valves may break**
  2021–2022 · NHTSA 24V-635
- ☐ **Rear shock reservoirs can corrode and detach**
  2021–2024 · NHTSA 25V-025
- ☐ **Molded-in-color hardtop roof panels can separate**
  2021–2022 · NHTSA 26V-299
- ☐ **Engine-compartment wiring harness can short**
  2021–2026 · NHTSA 26V-468
- ☐ **Steering gear internal damage**
  2022 Raptor · 2023 Wildtrak · NHTSA 23V-155
- ☐ **Transmission-to-transfer-case joint misaligned after a previous repair**
  2021–2025 · NHTSA 26V-236
- ☐ **Front upper control-arm ball-joint nut loose or missing**
  2024–2025 · NHTSA 24V-770 · 25V-260 · 25V-310
- ☐ **Front lower control-arm fasteners not tightened**
  2024–2025 · NHTSA 25V-308
- ☐ **Fender flares may detach**
  2022–2026 · NHTSA 26V-403
- ☐ **Windshield not properly bonded**
  2022 (and 2025, 25V-683) · NHTSA 22V-451

## IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Real Sasquatch**
  315/70R17 tires on 17×8.5, +30 mm wheels and 4.7 axle gears. Standard wheels are +55 mm. Confirm with the window sticker or build data.
- ☐ **Bronco Raptor**
  Four-door only. 'FORD' spelled across the grille (other trims say BRONCO), an 85.7-inch-wide body with extra marker lights, 37-inch tires, Fox suspension and a 3.0 V6 with 418 hp.
- ☐ **Suspension level**
  Badlands (and Sasquatch) trucks have position-sensitive Bilstein dampers (HOSS 2.0) and a hydraulic front sway-bar disconnect. Wildtrak trucks have Fox dampers (HOSS 3.0). From 2025, Badlands buyers could add the full HOSS 3.0 package.
- ☐ **First Edition**
  2021 only: Badlands mechanicals with Wildtrak exterior styling and the Outer Banks interior, and 35s standard.
- ☐ **Which top**
  Original molded-in-color, replacement 'MIC 2.0', or painted (2023 Heritage editions, then optional from 2025). A crazed or delaminated MIC top is a recall and program candidate.

## NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/bronco/sixth-gen/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks